GCPRO
RECOVER • RESTORE • REBUILD

24-HOUR EMERGENCY SERVICE
(847) 656-3322

HOW THE AGENCY SUPPORT PROGRAM (ASP) HELPS AGENTS HANDLE QUESTIONABLE OR UNCOVERED LOSSES



There is perhaps no bigger customer service challenge than dealing with questionable or uncovered claims. If a potentially serious and costly loss has occurred and there is no coverage, this can be a massively negative Moment of Truth for your insured. Instead of creating a Cheerleader, you may be creating a Terrorist!

Many times, there is no way for you, as the agent, to know whether the loss is covered or is claim worthy without seeing it for yourself. And that's where the Agency Support Program comes in! We'll go out and perform a free inspection and be your eyes and ears on the loss. We'll collect the necessary information, take pictures and scans and communicate back to you so you and the policyholder can make an informed decision based on coverage and severity of the damage. This helps protect your loss ratio by helping your insureds make smart decisions about filing claims. You won't be dinged with marginal claims and your insureds are less likely to be rated or cancelled (which can happen from just making an inquiry about a claim!)

DEALING WITH RISING WATER, SUMP PUMP FAILURE, AND SEWER BACKUP DAMAGE

These types of losses have several challenging aspects. First, the Standard of Care requires a higher level of removal and replacement of affected materials as well as stringent disinfection protocols to address hazards from human waste, disease causing pathogens and toxic materials. This makes them substantially more expensive to restore than clean water damage.

Second, most standard homeowner's policies have no (or limited) coverage for these types of losses unless the insured has purchased a rider or endorsement.

WHAT IF THERE IS NO COVERAGE?

It is a quirk of human nature that we rarely act until we are in crisis. This might explain why some policyholders dismiss additional riders that would be of great value

should they experience the problem. Interestingly, a MetLife Insurance Literacy survey confirmed that "more than two-thirds of consumers surveyed also said they'd rather pay a higher premium than be told that a loss isn't covered." But what is often the reality is that insureds are so concerned about the lowest price at the time of policy purchase that they do not choose additional coverage. Many agents have forms that they ask such policyholders to sign and place in their file, knowing that if such a loss were to occur, the agent will be blamed for the lack of coverage.

HOW THE ASP HELPS SOFTEN THE BLOW OF UNCOVERED LOSSES

- We provide a free, enhanced, high-tech inspection when losses occur. We will act as your eyes and ears on the job, providing information that will help you and the insured decide whether a loss is claimworthy or not. This inspection is presented as being provided at no charge on your behalf to highlight the value you are delivering.
- We execute "planned reputation enhancement" to enhance your image with your policyholders. This takes advantage of the power of the "independent third-party endorsement".
- When we see a potentially uncovered loss (such as a sewer back-up), we will reach out to you to confirm the lack of coverage (if you haven't already informed us). Our techs say, "It's ultimately up to the adjuster, and we're not adjusters, but this type of loss is typically not covered by a standard Homeowner's Policy."
- Before they call you (with a full head of steam) we take the first punch in the gut, let them vent and give them a "shoulder to cry on". We reinforce the fact that we are there to help them because you sent us. We explain that things are not always covered and provide alternatives.
- And just before they pick up the phone, we perform a very important "service recovery" act that reinforces that you sent us. We also said good things about you, delivered the free inspection on your behalf and we'll help them get back to normal if they want us to. We do all of this to try to serve you and your policyholder so that we can all get through this together and that you can retain their business.

Working together, your agency and our company can provide the highest levels of customer service, even in the most challenging situations.

The Agency Support Program can add powerful marketing and sales tools to your selling efforts at no cost to you! To learn about all the details of the ASP, contact:

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